

Absolutely — **gentle** is a strong polysemy target because your passage uses it here:

> “Unlike dramatic or heavy paintings, it felt **gentle** and almost dreamlike...”

Here **gentle** means **soft, calm, and not emotionally harsh or intense**. But the word also commonly describes **people, movement, physical force, slopes, sounds, treatment, exercise, and changes**.

Word family: **gentle / gently / gentleness**

Base word: gentle

Adverb: gently

Noun: gentleness

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞)

Meaning in your passage: **gentle = soft, calm, not harsh or intense — 柔和的 ; 溫和的**

Your sentence:

> “It felt **gentle** and almost dreamlike.”

Here **gentle** means:

> **having a soft, calm, soothing quality rather than a strong, dramatic, harsh, or aggressive one.**

繁體中文 :

給人柔和、平靜、舒緩的感覺，不強烈、不尖銳、不具壓迫感

Natural translation:

> “It felt gentle and almost dreamlike.”

「它給人的感覺很**柔和**，幾乎像夢境一樣。」

So here:

> **gentle = 視覺 / 氣氛上柔和、平靜、不強烈的**

1. **gentle = kind, calm, and not rough with people/animals — 溫柔的 ; 和善的**

A core personality/behaviour meaning.

Practice 1

> “She is very **gentle** with children.”

「她對孩子非常**溫柔**。」

Practice 2

> “The dog has a gentle nature.”

「這隻狗性情很**溫順 / 溫和**。」

****gentle = 對人或動物態度和善、不粗暴、不具攻擊性****

2. ****gentle = soft and soothing in feeling/style — 柔和的；溫和的****

This is your exact source sense.

Practice 3 — Original

> “The painting felt **gentle** and almost dreamlike.”

「這幅畫給人的感覺很**柔和**，幾乎像夢境一樣。」

Practice 4

> “The room was filled with gentle colours.”

「房間裡充滿**柔和的色彩**。」

****gentle = 在視覺、氣氛、風格或情緒上不強烈、不刺眼、不具壓迫感****

3. ****gentle = not strong or forceful physically — 輕柔的；力度小的****

A major physical-force meaning.

Practice 5

> “Use **gentle pressure** when cleaning the surface.”

「清潔表面時要用**輕柔的力度**。」

Practice 6

> “She gave the door a gentle push.”

「她**輕輕地推**了一下門。」

gentle = 所用力量較小，不猛烈、不粗暴

4. **gentle = gradual, not steep — 平緩的；和緩的**

A common landscape/geometry use.

Practice 7

> “The path has a **gentle slope**.”

「這條路的斜坡很**平緩**。」

Practice 8

> “The hill rises in a gentle curve.”

「山坡以一道**和緩的曲線**上升。」

gentle = 坡度、曲線或變化不陡、不急

5. **gentle = mild, not severe — 溫和的；不劇烈的**

A broader intensity sense.

Practice 9

> “We went for some **gentle exercise**.”

「我們做了一些**輕量 / 溫和的運動**。」

Practice 10

> “The doctor recommended gentle stretching.”

「醫生建議做一些**溫和的伸展**。」

****gentle = 強度低、不劇烈，適合慢慢進行****

6. ****gentle = quiet/soft in sound — 輕柔的；柔和的****

A sound-related use.

Practice 11

> “A ****gentle voice**** came from the next room.”

「隔壁房間傳來一把****輕柔的聲音****。」

Practice 12

> “The music has a gentle rhythm.”

「這首音樂有一種****柔和的節奏****。」

****gentle = 聲音不響亮、不刺耳，聽起來平和舒適****

7. ****gentle = mild in weather/nature — 和煦的；輕柔的****

A common weather/nature sense.

Practice 13

> “A ****gentle breeze**** moved across the lake.”

「一陣****微風****吹過湖面。」

Practice 14

> “A gentle rain began to fall.”

「天空開始下起****柔和的小雨 / 細雨****。」

****gentle = 風、雨等自然現象力度不大、較柔和****

8. ****gentle = careful and delicate with an object/body part — 輕手輕腳的；小心的****

A treatment/handling meaning.

Practice 15

> “Be **gentle** with the old painting.”

「對這幅舊畫要**小心輕柔地處理**。」

Practice 16

> “Use a gentle touch around the damaged area.”

「在受損位置附近要用**輕柔手法**處理。」

gentle = 處理脆弱物件 / 身體部位時避免用力過猛

9. **gentle** = gradual / not abrupt in change — 緩慢的；平緩的

A common abstract change meaning.

Practice 17

> “There was a **gentle change** in colour from blue to green.”

「藍色到綠色之間有一個**柔和漸變**。」

Practice 18

> “The music ends with a gentle transition.”

「音樂以一段**平緩的過渡**結束。」

gentle = 變化發生得自然、逐步，不突然

10. **gently** = softly / carefully / with little force — 輕輕地；溫柔地

A major adverb form.

Practice 19

> “She **gently** touched the frame.”

「她**輕輕地**碰了一下畫框。」

Practice 20

> “The colours blend gently into one another.”

「那些顏色彼此**柔和地**融合。」

****gently = 以輕柔、和緩、不粗暴的方式****

11. ****gently = gradually / mildly — 緩緩地；平穩地****

Practice 21

> “The road slopes ****gently**** downward.”

「道路**緩緩地**向下傾斜。」

Practice 22

> “The light faded gently across the water.”

「光線在水面上**緩緩淡去**。」

****gently = 以平緩、漸進的方式****

12. ****gentleness = kindness / softness — 溫柔；柔和；溫和****

A related noun.

Practice 23

> “She spoke with great ****gentleness****.”

「她說話時非常**溫柔**。」

Practice 24

> “The gentleness of the colours makes the painting calming.”

「色彩的**柔和感**令這幅畫讓人感到平靜。」

****gentleness = 溫柔、不粗暴、柔和或不強烈的特質****

Important distinction: ****gentle vs soft****

****soft****

very broad:

- * not hard
- * quiet
- * smooth
- * low in intensity

****gentle****

often emphasizes:

- * low force
- * calmness
- * kindness
- * lack of harshness

> soft fabric

> = 柔軟布料

> gentle person

> = 溫柔的人

> gentle colours

> = 柔和色彩

They overlap, but not always.

Important distinction: ****gentle vs mild****

****mild****

= not severe, strong, spicy, or extreme.

****gentle****

= soft, calm, low-force, non-harsh.

> mild weather

> = 溫和天氣

> gentle breeze

> = 微風

> mild pain

> = 輕微疼痛

> gentle touch

> = 輕柔觸碰

Different typical collocations.

Important distinction: **gentle vs calm**

calm

= not agitated, excited, rough, or disturbed.

gentle

= soft and not forceful/harsh.

> calm person

> = 冷靜的人

> gentle person

> = 溫柔的人

> calm sea

> = 平靜的海面

> gentle waves

> = 柔和的小浪

Important distinction: **gentle vs kind**

kind

= caring/helpful toward others.

gentle

= kind in a soft, non-harsh way.

Someone can be kind but quite direct or energetic.

Gentle adds:

> softness in manner.

Important distinction: **gentle vs delicate**

delicate

can mean:

* easily damaged

* fine/subtle

* requiring care

gentle

describes the low-force treatment/style itself.

> delicate painting

> = 脆弱 / 精緻的畫作

> gentle handling

> = 輕柔處理

Important distinction: **gentle vs subtle**

Your passage also contains **subtle** later.

gentle

= soft, calm, not forceful.

subtle

= not obvious; fine and difficult to notice.

> gentle colour

> = 柔和色彩

> subtle colour difference

> = 細微、不易察覺的色差

A painting may be both gentle and subtle, but for different reasons.

Important distinction: **gentle vs weak**

gentle

often positive:

controlled, soft, moderate.

weak

= lacking strength/power.

> gentle pressure

> = 有意控制的輕柔力度

> weak pressure

> = 力度不足

Not interchangeable.

Important distinction: **gentle vs slow**

gentle

can describe the **degree/intensity** of change.

slow

describes the **speed**.

> gentle transition

> = 平緩過渡

> slow transition

> = 過渡速度慢

Often related, but conceptually different.

Important distinction: **gentle slope vs slight slope**

gentle slope

= not steep.

slight slope

= small degree of slope.

They are close, but **gentle** often feels more natural in landscape descriptions.

Important distinction: **gentle person vs gentle painting**

Same word, different domain:

Person

> gentle = 溫柔 / 和善

Painting

> gentle = 柔和 / 平靜、不強烈

The underlying concept is the same:

> **not harsh, rough, or forceful**

So these should be merged conceptually rather than treated as unrelated dictionary senses.

Important distinction: **gentle touch — literal vs figurative**

Literal

> “Use a gentle touch.”

= 動作輕柔。

Figurative

> “The room needs a gentle touch.”

= 房間需要較柔和 / 細膩的處理方式。

Same underlying sense of subtle, non-forceful treatment.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

- * **gentle — person/behaviour** = 溫柔 / 和善的
- * **gentle — atmosphere/style** = 柔和 / 平靜的
- * **gentle — force** = 輕柔 / 力度小的
- * **gentle — slope/curve** = 平緩的
- * **gentle — exercise/intensity** = 溫和 / 不劇烈的
- * **gentle — sound** = 輕柔的
- * **gentle — weather/nature** = 和煦 / 輕柔的
- * **gentle — handling** = 小心輕柔的
- * **gentle — change/transition** = 漸進 / 平緩的
- * **gently — manner** = 輕輕地 / 溫柔地
- * **gently — gradual movement** = 緩緩地
- * **gentleness** = 溫柔 / 柔和 / 溫和

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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gentle — person/behaviour	對人或動物和善、不粗暴、不具攻擊性的
gentle — style/atmosphere	給人柔和、平靜、舒緩而不強烈的感覺
gentle — physical force	使用力度較小、不猛烈或粗暴的
gentle — slope/curve	坡度或曲線不陡、不急的
gentle — exercise/intensity	強度低、不劇烈的
gentle — sound	聲音柔和、不響亮、不刺耳的
gentle — weather	風、雨等力度較小、柔和的
gentle — handling	處理脆弱物件或身體部位時小心、輕柔的
gentle — change	變化自然、逐步、沒有突然轉折的
gently	以輕柔、和緩、不粗暴或漸進的方式
gentleness	溫柔、不粗暴、柔和或不強烈的特質

For your original sentence

> “Unlike dramatic or heavy paintings, it felt **gentle** and almost dreamlike...”

The exact meaning is:

gentle = 這幅畫在色彩、氣氛和視覺感受上都不強烈、不壓迫，而是柔和、安靜、舒緩的。

Natural translation:

> **「不像那些戲劇性強烈或沉重的畫作，它給人的感覺很柔和，幾乎像夢境一樣。」**

The highest-value contrasts are:

> **gentle person** → 溫柔 / 和善的人

> **gentle colours** → 柔和色彩

> **gentle pressure** → 輕柔力度

> **gentle slope** → 平緩斜坡

> **gentle exercise** → 溫和運動

> **gentle voice** → 輕柔聲音

> **gentle breeze** → 微風

> **gently** → 輕輕地 / 緩緩地

> **gentleness** → 溫柔 / 柔和感